

Monthly Circles and Quarterly Open Sessions

- Setaweet's Monthly Circles and Quarterly Open Sessions emerged following the movement's inception in July 2014 as a space for Ethiopian women advocating for gender equality and feminist solidarity.
- The gatherings were organized in response to the death of sixteen-year-old Hanna Lalango in November 2014, which galvanized conversations around gender-based violence and women's safety in Ethiopia.
- The Monthly Circles brought women together every second Tuesday of the month to share personal experiences, discuss gender-related challenges, and build support networks in a safe and inclusive environment.
- As participation expanded, the initiative evolved into Setaweet Open Sessions, which welcomed both women and men from the public into broader discussions on feminism, gender justice, and social issues.
- Through consistent dialogue and community-building, the circles and open sessions contributed to the growth of feminist organizing, collective awareness, and grassroots activism in Ethiopia.

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- Arif Abbat (translating to 'great father') was a photo competition initiative implemented between 2017 and 2019 to promote positive representations of fatherhood and shared parenting responsibilities in Ethiopian society.
- The project invited participants to submit photographs that reflected gender equality, care work, and fathers' active involvement in raising children.
- The first exhibition and competition was held at Addis Ababa Museum in December 2017, followed by #ArifAbbat 2.0 in Mekelle City in March 2019.
- Submitted photographs were selected based on their social messages and contribution to conversations around gender norms and caregiving.
- Through visual storytelling and public exhibition, the project challenged traditional expectations around parenting roles and encouraged more equitable family dynamics.

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- Min Lebsa Neber (#WhatSheWore) was a traveling exhibition project implemented between 2018 and 2020 in Addis Ababa, Gondar, Wolaita, and Dire Dawa.
- The exhibition displayed clothes worn by survivors at the time of their sexual assault alongside personal testimonies and stories shared by the survivors themselves.

- The project was first presented at Addis Ababa Museum between November 25 and December 10, 2018, as a collaboration between Setaweet, the Embassy of Sweden, and UN Women. The final showcase was hosted at the Goethe-Institut Addis Ababa.
- Additional editions of the exhibition were later organized in Gondar, Wolaita, and Dire Dawa, expanding public engagement and regional accessibility.
- By confronting harmful victim-blaming narratives, the exhibition raised awareness about sexual violence and encouraged public dialogue on survivor experiences, accountability, and empathy.

Gendershops

- The gendershops were a feminist curriculum and workshop initiative implemented between 2018 and 2024 for secondary school and university students in Ethiopia
- The project created participatory learning spaces that explored issues including femininities and masculinities, healthy relationships, self-esteem, beauty standards, and gender norms.
- Conducted as interactive two-day workshops, the gender shops encouraged students to critically examine stereotypes and rethink socially assigned gender roles.
- Between 2018 and 2019, the program reached more than 2,200 students across six schools in Addis Ababa, and later expanded to include university students and young married women.
- By fostering dialogue, solidarity, and awareness around toxic masculinity and gender-based violence, the initiative contributed to safer and more inclusive school and community environments.

(To go on the website with the Manual both in Amharic and English)

አለጃታ Hotline

- Operating from 2019 to 2025, the Alegnta Hotline was a free, nationwide psycho-social support service established by Setaweet to assist survivors of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV).
- Accessible in Amharic, Afaan Oromo, and Sidama Afo, the hotline was designed to ensure inclusivity and reach individuals across diverse regions of Ethiopia.
- With the support of UN Women and Ethio Telecom, Alegnta had evolved into a critical first-response mechanism, providing immediate, confidential, and professional counseling services delivered by trained specialists.

- Beyond emotional support, the hotline functioned as a key referral and information hub, connecting callers to essential services including healthcare providers, legal institutions, one-stop centers, and in-person counseling resources. Its impact extends to mitigating the long-term psychological effects of violence by promoting recovery, resilience, and informed decision-making among survivors.
- By restoring a sense of agency and providing accessible pathways to support, the Alegnta Hotline played a vital role in strengthening community responses to SGBV.

(To go on the website along with the corresponding YouTube links and audio file)

<https://youtu.be/MU6e4660QIM?si=YZmo-5Qx3qYJhbSJ>

<https://youtu.be/g5vllZHto6U?si=lsemxd6UvWka5BgO>

Writing our rights

- Setaweeet organized the 1st Annual All-Women in Ethiopian Academia Conference (AWEAC) in Addis Ababa in November 2019 under the theme “*Writing Our Rights.*”
- The conference brought together women researchers and academics from across Ethiopia to present work on representation, exclusion, democracy, media, arts, and gendered identities.
- The event created a platform for feminist academic dialogue and highlighted women’s perspectives within Ethiopian research and public discourse.
- Following the conference, Setaweeet published peer-reviewed articles by women scholars on gender, motherhood, intersectionality, narratives, and women’s representation in Ethiopia.
- The journal, *Writing our Rights*, contributed to strengthening feminist scholarship and expanding the visibility of women in Ethiopian academia.

(To go on the website along with the booklet as is)

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- Launched in 2020, *MeQenet* is Setaweeet’s talk-show style documentary series that first aired on Arts TV before continuing its reach on YouTube, expanding accessibility to a broader audience.
- The series engaged with everyday Ethiopian realities through a distinctly feminist lens, interrogating social, cultural, and political issues while challenging dominant narratives that shape public understanding.

- By combining dialogue, critical analysis, and storytelling, *MeQenet* created a reflective space that not only highlights gendered dimensions of societal issues but also raises fundamental questions about the meaning and practice of feminism within the Ethiopian context.
- As part of its broader impact, the project contributed to the articulation of an Ethiopian feminist framework and the development of a localized feminist agenda.
- Through its emphasis on dialogue and knowledge-sharing, *MeQenet* also serves as a tool for strengthening grassroots women's movements, fostering awareness, and supporting capacity-building efforts that encourage sustained engagement with feminist thought and advocacy.

Data Project

- The Data Project was launched in 2021 to strengthen gender-based violence reporting systems and improve data management within police institutions in Ethiopia.
- As part of the initiative, Setaweet developed the Alegnta Mobile App, which enables survivors and witnesses of gender-based violence to anonymously report incidents occurring in public and private spaces.
- In collaboration with the digital marketing company social.ly, the project also developed and updated software used by the Addis Ababa Police Commission to improve GBV data collection and case management procedures.
- The software was installed across sub-city police stations and supported police officers in standardizing intake forms and documenting gender-based violence cases more effectively.
- By improving reporting mechanisms, follow-up procedures, and institutional data systems, the project contributed to more responsive and survivor-centered approaches to addressing gender-based violence.

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- Tesfaweet, the Married Girls' Project, was implemented in Debre Tabor and the South Gondar area beginning in 2021 to support girls and young women affected by child marriage.
- The project provided empowerment training, livelihood support, and raw materials that enabled participants to establish micro-poultry farms and small-scale spice preparation and distribution businesses.
- Through workshops and community engagement activities, Tesfaweet addressed inequalities in access to education, economic opportunities, and social support systems.

- The initiative built on the success of CARE Ethiopia's TESFA Project and focused particularly on married girls in Farta Woreda, where child marriage remained a significant gender equality challenge.
- By strengthening financial independence and community participation among young married women, the project created opportunities for long-term empowerment and social inclusion.

(To go on the website with the Tesfaweeet manual as is)

Policy Dialogues

- The Policy Dialogues series was implemented between January 2021 and June 2022 in Addis Ababa through a collaboration between Setaweet and FES-FMCC to advance feminist policy engagement and (re)politicize gender equality in Ethiopia.
- The initiative organized five major dialogues focused on constitutional reform, gender and migration, women and conflict, peace-building, and feminist movement-building, bringing together academics, activists, women's rights organizations, and legal experts.
- The dialogues created spaces for critical discussion on issues including gender-based violence, migration, transitional justice, constitutional reform, conflict-related violence, and women's participation in peace and national dialogue processes.
- The project strengthened collaboration among women's rights organizations and supported the development of shared feminist agendas and policy recommendations.
- The series contributed to expanding feminist policy discourse in Ethiopia by creating platforms for alliance-building, knowledge-sharing, and collective advocacy around women's rights, peace-building, and accountability.

Women's National Agenda (Under this project, we have the National Women's Forum and the National Women's Conference)

National Women's Forum

- The National Women's Forum was held in Bishoftu in June 2022, bringing together close to one hundred women from several regions of Ethiopia to discuss contemporary women's issues and feminist organizing.
- The forum created a national space for women's rights advocates, activists, and organizations to deliberate on key social, political, and gender-related challenges affecting Ethiopian women.

- Discussions focused on peace-building, solidarity, women's participation in national processes, and the development of shared priorities for the women's movement in Ethiopia.
- The gathering encouraged collaboration and alliance-building among women from diverse regional and organizational backgrounds while strengthening feminist networks across the country.
- The forum contributed to building a stronger and more connected feminist movement by creating opportunities for collective strategizing, dialogue, and long-term movement-building.

National Women's Conference

- The National Women's Conference was held in April 2023 at the Hilton Hotel in Addis Ababa, bringing together hundreds of Ethiopian women for a two-day gathering focused on feminist movement-building and peace-building.
- The conference included keynote speeches, documentary screenings, breakout sessions, and experience-sharing discussions on conflict, humanitarian response, women's participation in peace processes, African feminism, and digital feminist organizing.
- Participants engaged in discussions on the role of women in the upcoming national dialogue process and reflected on the priorities and future direction of the feminist movement in Ethiopia.
- The conference created a platform for women's rights advocates and organizations from across the country to learn from one another, strengthen solidarity, and develop collaborative approaches to addressing contemporary issues affecting women.
- As the concluding event in the Policy Dialogues series, the conference strengthened feminist networks and contributed to advancing collective advocacy, sisterhood, and movement-building efforts in Ethiopia.

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- Meseret was implemented from August 2022 to March 2025 in Tigray and Addis Ababa in partnership with Addis Powerhouse. The project was deployed with financial support from the Spanish Cooperation and in collaboration with local organizations, including N4ED, Teki Paper Bags, Yamlak Lijoch Aras Bet Foundation, and Chura Abugida Artistic Association.
- Meseret focused on strengthening feminist movements in Ethiopia through women's circles that created supportive spaces for women and girls to discuss social issues, exchange experiences, and build solidarity at the grassroots level.
- Through weekly feminist dialogue sessions, business development trainings, and project planning workshops, the initiative combined feminist movement-building with economic empowerment for women from marginalized and conflict-affected communities.
- The project supported diverse groups including new mothers, deaf women

workers, and survivors of conflict-related sexual violence. The circles met weekly for six sessions each to work through the feminist content developed by Setaweet. The content was tailored for each of the groups, and in the case of the group at Adigrat, it was interpreted into Tigrinya with the support of an external facilitator.

- Meseret contributed to strengthening feminist organizing and local leadership by building networks among women's groups, expanding economic opportunities for participants, and promoting healing, self-confidence, and collective action among women across regions.

Transitional Justice

The Transitional Justice initiative was implemented in Addis Ababa in March 2024 through two consecutive gatherings focused on women's experiences in conflict and gender-responsive transitional justice processes.

- The first event, YeSetoch Wulo, brought together 45 women frontline responders, human rights advocates, and women's rights organizations from six regions and Addis Ababa to share experiences and reflect on transitional justice.
- Immediately following the gathering, Setaweet organized a two-day Writeshop titled "Input to Transitional Justice and Strategic Litigation Efforts," which convened 25 participants to discuss concerns, hopes, and feminist perspectives on Ethiopia's transitional justice process.
- The initiative created a safe and collaborative space for women affected by conflict and women advocates to contribute directly to national conversations on accountability, justice, and peace-building.
- The project resulted in the development of a feminist position statement advocating for a gender-responsive approach to transitional justice and strengthened collaboration among women working on conflict and human rights issues.

(To go on the website along with the invitation letter to YeSetoch Wulo/ the Writeshop as well as the position statement (March 2024))

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- *Misikir* is a feminist documentary film developed between 2023 and 2025 across the Afar, Amhara, Benishangul-Gumuz, and Tigray regions of Ethiopia, centering the lived experiences of women in displacement camps directly impacted by armed conflict.
- Through an intimate and grounded storytelling approach, the film documents the multifaceted consequences of conflicts that began in November 2020 in Tigray and extended into neighboring regions, as well as the continued effects of inter-communal violence in Oromia and Benishangul-Gumuz.
- The title, derived from the Amharic word for "witness," reflects both the film's narrative purpose and its political stance: to foreground women as authoritative narrators of their own histories. The deliberate use of "Misikir", a name more

commonly perceived as masculine, signals a conscious feminist choice to challenge entrenched norms around credibility, voice, and testimony.

- Rather than reproducing reductionist portrayals of women's suffering, *Misikir* adopts a feminist lens that prioritizes specificity and agency, presenting selected narratives that range from bereavement and displacement to resilience and survival.
- By drawing connections across geographically and culturally distinct communities, the documentary highlights the shared, gendered dimensions of conflict while fostering empathy and solidarity among women. In doing so, *Misikir* contributes a critical counter-narrative to dominant discourses, offering a nuanced and ethically grounded account of women's experiences in times of crisis.

(To go on the website with the corresponding YouTube links)

<https://youtu.be/mPhti0ydKLk?si=xm48XjblTn7DULuc>
<https://youtu.be/cwBnliQaljQ?si=O3xIER7Y0vubq9pW>

Humanitarian Support

- Setaweet's Humanitarian Support project was implemented in November 2024 at the Shimelaku IDP Camp in Dabat Woreda, North Gondar, Amhara Region to support conflict-affected internally displaced women and girls.
- The project focused on women-headed households, survivors of gender-based violence, women with disabilities, and adolescent girls through the distribution of dignity kits and targeted cash assistance.
- A total of 800 women and girls received dignity kits designed to meet UNFPA minimum standards, while 340 women-headed households received two months of cash assistance totaling 14,000 Birr per household to support urgent livelihood needs.
- The initiative addressed immediate psychosocial, health, and economic challenges faced by displaced women while promoting dignity, agency, and access to essential resources in crisis settings.
- Recognized by the Bureau of Women and Social Affairs (BoWSA), the project marked one of the first large-scale gender-sensitive humanitarian interventions in the area and strengthened Setaweet's capacity in feminist humanitarian response and survivor-centered support.

Leddoki

- Leddoki was implemented in Hawassa and other cities in the Sidama Region in 2025 as part of a project titled "Promoting Inclusiveness in Society through Rights-Based Research, Dialogue, and Advocacy."
- The initiative focused on strengthening grassroots women's movements and advancing gender justice through community dialogue, advocacy, and

capacity-building activities.

- The project created safe spaces for discussions around gender-based violence while supporting survivors through community-centered engagement and solidarity-building efforts.
- Through the establishment of Setaweet circles and facilitation training, the project strengthened local leadership capacities and encouraged community-led initiatives.
- By increasing volunteer engagement and expanding local advocacy networks, Leddoki contributed to more inclusive and sustainable community responses to gender inequality and violence.

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- Details already available to Gezat communications.

(To go on the website, along with the Negari booklet as is)

Trauma Healing Work

- Setaweet's Trauma Healing Work was implemented in Adigrat, Tigray in late 2023 and expanded to Debre Birhan in 2025–2026 to support conflict-affected women, families, and internally displaced communities through trauma-informed interventions.
- The project reached over 100 women in Adigrat and more than 700 women and men in Debre Birhan through trauma-healing workshops, group counseling sessions, and community-based psychosocial support activities.
- Working in partnership with local organizations including YWCA Debre Birhan, the initiative trained facilitators and community members to lead trauma-healing and counseling sessions tailored to the needs of conflict-affected communities.
- In addition to psychosocial support, the project provided survivor assistance through the distribution of essential items including raincoats and children's rain boots to internally displaced families living in camps in the Amhara Region.
- The project contributed to strengthening community resilience and survivor support systems by combining trauma-healing, community care, and humanitarian assistance for conflict-affected populations, while continuing documentation and healing efforts into 2026.

(To go on the website along with the LeMaleda booklet as is)

Advocacy Campaign (Under this Category we have Ahunem Alrefedem, Lek Adelem and

Unveiling Stories)

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- Implemented across Addis Ababa and other major cities between December 2022 and March 2023, the Ahunim Alrefedem campaign, along with the Lik Aydelem campaign, stood as a multifaceted advocacy initiative addressing the experiences of women affected by gender-based violence during the war.
- The name “Ahunim Alrefedem”, which translates to “It’s still not late” emphasized that meaningful action and justice remain possible, positioning the campaign as both a call to accountability and a collective refusal to accept silence in the face of violence.
- Through a strategic combination of radio ads, social media outreach, curated screenings of the *Misikir* documentary, as well as public wall art and murals, the campaign sought to amplify survivors’ voices while fostering national awareness and accountability.
- The campaign engaged mainstream media platforms, including planned radio advertisements on Sheger 102.1 FM and participation in the Endalk ena Mahder program, where members of the Setawee team discussed both the campaign’s significance and their experience producing *Misikir*.

(To go on the website along with the corresponding YouTube video link and audio file)

<https://youtu.be/Gkxkp6VoSEQ?si=ZcDDTPhYKG3hXL8P>

The proposed navigation structure is as follows:

- The Setaweet Story
 - Setaweet Story
 - Setaweet Milestone
 - Setaweet in Media
- Impact Map
- Call for Action

Setaweet in Media

- <https://www.instagram.com/p/DMNYneYNkHZ/?igsh=NTRlbTlwOTNkZWM5>

Setaweet Milestone

- **10th anniversary celebration** (The invite to go on the website, along with photos from the event)